

Roof Leak Early Detection Prevention — Action Checklist

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INTERIOR ATTIC INSPECTION

- ☐ **Interior Attic Inspection:** Check rafters and sheathing for water stains, looking for brown or tan discoloration, dark streaks running down wood surfaces, and any wood that feels softer than surrounding areas.
- ☐ **Interior Attic Inspection:** Look for daylight visible through roof sheathing from inside the attic, since any gap that allows light to pass through will also allow water infiltration.
- ☐ **Interior Attic Inspection:** Examine insulation for dampness or mold growth by identifying matted or discolored insulation and white or gray fuzzy patches indicating mold development.
- ☐ **Interior Attic Inspection:** Document all findings with photographs taken from multiple angles, dating each image and comparing against previous inspections to track any changes over time.

EXTERIOR LADDER INSPECTION

- ☐ **Exterior Ladder Inspection:** Inspect pipe boots from the ladder at gutter level, checking for cracks, gaps, missing sealant, or rubber collar deterioration that commonly causes leaks.
- ☐ **Exterior Ladder Inspection:** Examine shingles while on the ladder for curling, cracking, missing pieces, or granule loss in gutters indicating aging and UV damage.
- ☐ **Exterior Ladder Inspection:** Inspect flashing at roof intersections with walls, chimneys, and skylights for rust, gaps, lifting edges, or missing sealant that could allow water intrusion.
- ☐ **Exterior Ladder Inspection:** Check gutters and valleys for debris accumulation and verify valleys show visible underlayment or metal flashing rather than direct shingle overlap.

ACT ON FINDINGS PROMPTLY

- ☐ **Act on Findings Promptly:** Replace pipe boots if your roof is over 10 years old and you've never done so, using Permaboot as a lead-free silicone option that installs without removing shingles for \$25-\$40.
 - ☐ **Act on Findings Promptly:** Install Permaboot within 20 minutes from a ladder as a DIY project when you identify cracked or deteriorating pipe boots on your exterior inspection.
 - ☐ **Act on Findings Promptly:** Schedule professional roof repair immediately upon discovering daylight through sheathing, soft rafters, or extensive mold growth in the attic that exceeds simple patching.
 - ☐ **Act on Findings Promptly:** Conduct inspections twice yearly in early spring and early fall to catch problems before they escalate into \$10,000+ structural damage scenarios.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.